

Final Project: Poster

Due December 11 at 5 PM

Your final project will represent the culmination of your research and will take the form of a poster. After completing your three checkpoint assignments, you will extend your empirical analyses to include a multivariate regression analysis and summarize the other components of your research into different “panels” in the poster. The poster should contain the following components:

- **Introduction:** A short introduction that motivates your topic and tells the reader why it is important to study.
- **Literature Review/Theory:** A short literature review/theory section (this is basically your Checkpoint 1 assignment!) that describes the previous literature and motivates a testable, falsifiable theory.
- **Hypothesis:** A clearly stated hypothesis (again, this is your Checkpoint 1!).
- **Methods/Data:**
 - How you measured your variables.
 - Basic info about your dataset: unit of analysis, time frame, case selection, etc.
 - Descriptive statistics that summarize your data.
 - The statistical method you use to test your theory and a justification for why you are using that method.
- **Results:**
 - A bivariate hypothesis test (t-test, chi-squared test, bivariate regression as appropriate) AND a multivariate linear or logistic regression as appropriate.
 - A regression table.
 - Brief discussion of model fit.
 - Brief discussion of statistical and substantive significance of important coefficients in your model.
- **Figure:** At least one figure used to either describe some important part of your data or visualization of results. This could be, for instance, the histogram (or a barplot) of your dependent variable, or a scatterplot showing the relationship between your dependent and independent variables.
- **Conclusion:** A conclusion that discusses strengths/limitations of your method/design and suggestions for future research.

In addition to your poster, you will also submit your replication dataset and a replication R script file commented in a way that allows me to see what R commands produced the results on your poster. I may replicate the results on your poster to double-check what you have done.

How do I make my poster?

The easiest way is to use PowerPoint. That's what I do. Make your poster as a single slide but change the size of that slide to a poster size (24 inches tall by 36 inches wide). I have uploaded a "template" poster to Canvas (Files > Final Project Instructions). You can simply download it to your computer, open it in PowerPoint, fill it in, and save it as a PDF.

One last point which is EXTREMELY important.

Please note that NOWHERE in the grading rubric (see below) is there a requirement that you find support for your theory. This is a class in political analysis. Your grade is determined by your ability to carry out a research project and conduct and interpret quantitative tests appropriately and correctly. If you find support for your hypothesis, great! If not, that is okay! This happens all the time! Your grade will not be adversely affected if you do not find support for your hypothesis.

Grading Rubric (15 Points)

Content and Completeness

- **Introduction (1 Point Total)**

- Full points (1.0): Provides an introduction that explains the importance of the topic.
- Partial points (0.5): Introduction is vague or does not clearly explain the importance of the topic.

- **Literature Review/Theory (1 Points Total)**

- Full points (2.0): Summarizes relevant literature (3-4 articles is enough) and provides a falsifiable theory.
- Partial points (1.0): Literature review is incomplete, or theory is not testable.

- **Hypothesis (1 Point Total)**

- Full points (1.0): Clearly states a hypothesis consistent with the theory.
- Partial points (0.5): Hypothesis is unclear or not directly connected to the theory.

- **Methods/Data (2 Points Total)**

- Full points (2.0): Describes variable measurement, dataset (unit of analysis, time frame, case selection, etc.), descriptive statistics, and justification for statistical method (e.g., linear vs logistic model).
- Partial points (1.0): Missing one or more components, or descriptions lack sufficient detail.

- **Results (5 Points Total)**

- Full points (5.0): Includes a bivariate hypothesis test, multivariate regression analysis, regression table, discussion of model fit, and interpretation of statistical/substantive significance.
- Partial points (3.5): Missing one key component (e.g., regression table, substantive significance discussion).
- Partial points (2): Missing two key components (e.g., regression table, substantive significance discussion).
- Partial points (0.5): Missing more than two key component.

- **Figure (1 Point Total)**

- Full points (1.0): Includes at least one relevant and well-constructed figure that effectively describes data or visualizes results.
- Partial points (0.5): Figure is included but lacks relevance, clarity, or proper labeling.

Organization and Presentation

- **Poster Layout and Panels (2 Points Total)**

- Full points (2.0): Information is organized into clear panels (e.g., Introduction, Methods, Results, etc.), with a logical layout.
- Partial points (1.0): Panels are present but not clearly organized.

- **Clarity and Conciseness (2 Points Total)**

- Full points (2.0): Content is clear, concise, and avoids unnecessary text while effectively communicating all key points.
- Partial points (1.0): Content is somewhat clear but overly verbose.